VMware joins Open-O to construct NFV future

VMware has joined the Linux Foundation-backed Open-O project to map the future of network functions virtualisation (NFV). The new development is aimed at bringing open standards-based orchestration to NFV infrastructure.

Joining the Open-O project as a platinum member, VMware will work with the government board as well as participate in its technical steering and marketing committees. The Dell subsidiary will also help enhance open standards-based orchestration in the networking world. "By joining Open-O, VMware is extending its position as a major player in defining the evolution and adoption of NFV by telcos and communications service providers," said Gabriele Di Piazza, vice president of solutions, Telco NFV Group at VMware.

The addition of VMware to the board will enhance Open-N capabilities to meet the demand for complex services over SDN (software-defined network) and NFV infrastructures, it is believed. "With the addition of leading NFV vendors such as VMware, we believe Open-O will successfully deliver the abstraction needed to deliver complex services over SDN and NFV infrastructures as well as legacy networks," said Marc Cohn, executive director, Open-O and vice president of network strategy, the Linux Foundation.

The Open-O project has operators such as China Mobile, China Telecom and Hong Kong Telecom (HKT). There are also over a billion mobile, residential and business users who will all enjoy an advanced experience through NFV vendors like VMware.

Last year, the company hired Gabriele Di Piazza as vice president of its telco NFV division to start developing new strategies around the advanced network architecture.

With the release of Windows Insider build 15002, Microsoft has brought about a large number of changes to its Bash, a.k.a. Linux command line interface. "A long list of improvements and fixes for Bash/WSL arrived in this build, resulting in even more compatibility, performance and stability of your favourite Linux tools

and technologies," wrote Rich Turner, senior program manager, Microsoft, in a blog post.

Through the latest release, all Bash sessions were created at the same permission level, and admin and non-admin consoles were restricted to operate simultaneously. Additionally, there are features such as the logging function and fixes for the truncated Windows path in WSL to mesh Linux with Windows 10.

The updated Bash on Windows comes with support for kernel memory over-commits. The way the process commit is calculated during a process fork has also been tweaked. Further, Microsoft has fixed the error code generation and enhanced VPN access through the command line tool.

While the latest Windows Insider preview brings about several enhancements, it also addresses some widely known issues on Bash. You are no longer able to use *Ctrl-C* in a Bash session. Turner stated that the console and Bash work just like two trains running on different tracks. Hence, the Ctrl-C command is now incompatible with Windows' Bash.

Bash is one of the first major developments by Microsoft to step into the world of open source. Debuted back in April 2016, the command line tool runs a standard Ubuntu distribution. It is available through Windows Insider releases.

Renault leverages open source to build electric car projects

Renault has announced its partnership with entities including OSVehicle, ARM, Pilot and Sensoria to develop its open source-powered electric car projects. At Consumer Electronics Show (CES) 2017, Renault-Nissan Alliance chairman and CEO, Carlos Ghosn, showcased a prototype of the ongoing developments.

Based on the existing electric car model Twizy, Renault has developed its very first open source model called POM. This new vehicle will be initially available to startups, independent laboratories, researchers and private customers. The French automaker has also allowed third parties to copy and modify the software behind the latest solution to develop customisable electric vehicles.

"Sharing common hardware platforms with everyone is a new co-creative and horizontal approach that can disrupt this industry, significantly lowering costs and time-to-market," said Tin Hang and Yuki Liu, founders of OSVehicle, in a joint statement.

In addition to the open software approach through OSVehicle, Renault's partnership with ARM will make the Twizy software and hardware architecture public. The ARM ecosystem for advanced vehicle technology includes support for ADAS (advanced driver assistance system), IVI (in-vehicle infotainment), autonomous driving, advanced cockpits and connected cars.